

Brief A: Supplier Invoice Matching

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Background

The Finance Department pays about 40 supplier invoices a week. Before an invoice is paid, an accounts executive matches it to its purchase order (PO) and the goods received note (GRN). This is the three-way match. It takes about six hours a week, and mistakes still get through.

How it works today

- Invoices arrive by email as PDFs and are typed into the invoice register
- The accounts executive finds the PO and the GRN for each invoice
- Quantity, unit price and total are compared by eye
- Matched invoices go to the Finance Director for payment approval; the rest wait for a phone call

The rules

- The unit price on the invoice must match the PO
- The quantity billed must not be more than the quantity received
- An invoice number from the same supplier can only be paid once
- Every invoice must quote a PO that exists
- Nothing is paid without the Finance Director's approval

Your data (October 2026)

File	What it holds
brief-a-purchase-orders.csv	12 purchase orders
brief-a-goods-received.csv	12 goods received notes
brief-a-invoices.csv	13 supplier invoices

What to design

A workflow that matches each invoice, sends matched invoices for payment approval, and sends every mismatch to a person with the reason. Test your design on the data: which invoices should it stop?

Use the AI Workflow Canvas (ai-workflow-canvas.docx) for your pitch. You have five minutes to present and three for questions. You'll be scored with the rubric on the Module 13 page.